

WHAT'S NEW IN TEA?

People may have started drinking tea hundreds of years ago, but a resurgent interest in the drink has led to a thriving new tea scene, which takes the best teas, traditions, and rituals from around the world and makes them part of our everyday lives.

MUCH ADO ABOUT MATCHA

Matcha is trending among health-conscious tea drinkers. This green tea-leaf powder can be consumed in a shot glass for a morning jolt of caffeine and antioxidants, as a creamy latté, mixed with fruits and ready to drink from the chiller cabinet, or in baked goods such as shortbread and macarons.

TEA MIXOLOGY

Mixologists have found tea's rich and refreshing variety of flavors a delectable addition to their stock of ingredients for cocktails. "Teatinis," martinis made using tea, have arrived at upscale bars, and can be easily prepared at home, too.

DESSERT TEA

Just as mixologists are experimenting with cocktails, tea blenders are innovating with "dessert tea" (see pp62-63)—taking inspiration from the dessert menu and recreating those flavors in delicious tea concoctions made using fruit, chocolate, and spices.

FERMEN-TEA-TION

Kombucha, the fizzy and fermented tea with powerful probiotic properties, is popping up in stores, bottled in multiple flavors, and in bars, as a cocktail ingredient, all around the world. Although readily available bottled, it is fun to make at home (see p174).

GOURMET TREAT

Gracing the tables of high-end restaurants, tea is fast becoming a popular food ingredient. Why not try tea recipes such as Masala Chai scones, green tea salad dressing, and Lapsang Souchong meat rubs.

